I have known Alexander Shapiro for more than three years. A. Shapiro graduated from the Mathematical Department at Moscow State University and is currently taking his graduate course at the same institution. Together with E.B.Vinberg, I have been his scientific supervisor for the last two years of his undergraduate study and up to now.

Within the five years of his basic education at the Mathematical Dept. of MSU Alexander Shapiro has proved to be one of the most gifted and active students. He has done his major at the Chair of Algebra, where he took courses of invariant theory, representation theory, basic homology algebra and algebraic geometry.

His diploma thesis is titled 'The weight function and universal R-matrix for twisted quantum affine algebra $U_q(A_2^{(2)})$'. A weight function is a family of elements of the Borel subalgebra of a quantum affine algebra, widely used in representation theory, as well as in mathematical physics, for constructing Bethe eigenvectors and solving Knizhnik-Zamolodchikov difference equations. Using the connection between two different descriptions of algebra $U_q(A_2^{(2)})$, A. Shapiro has managed to derive certain recurrence relations between those elements and finally to present explicit expressions for them. Now he continues his studies in the representation theory of deformed affine Lie algebras and their applications in mathematical physics.

A.Shapiro promises to become a qualified mathematician. Attending the Summer School in Bremen will definitely be very useful for him. I would be thankful to the organizers if they could find the possibility to support his application.

S.Khoroshkin, ITEP, Moscow.